

Change Management Process

Syed Motors · Document Code: PROC-02 · Type: process_manual · Department: IT

Purpose

This process defines how changes to the DMS, showroom kiosks and workshop tooling are proposed, approved, deployed and rolled back at Syed Motors.

The process provides a controlled route for recording a requested change, determining the applicable approval path, deploying the change outside business hours, verifying the result and restoring the previous state when issues occur.

Effective from the first working day of the current calendar year. Reviewed annually by the document owner and revised as necessary. Version 1.0.

1. Request

A change request is filed on the IT service portal with description, business justification, requested date and rollback plan.

Required request information

The description explains what is being changed. The business justification records why the change is needed. The requested date identifies when the change is intended to occur, while the rollback plan describes the planned response if the change causes issues.

These fields provide the information needed to review a change before deployment and establish a record that can be referred to during verification or rollback.

Change categories

Standard changes follow a pre-approved template. Normal changes go through the change advisory board. The category therefore determines the approval route that applies to the request.

Change Management Process — Requests and Classification

1. Request

All changes covered by this process begin with a change request on the IT service portal. The request is the formal record used to describe the proposed change and its supporting business need.

Description

The description should identify the system or tooling affected and explain the change being proposed. For DMS, showroom kiosk or workshop tooling changes, the record should make the intended modification understandable to the people reviewing it.

Business justification

The business justification records the reason for the change. It connects the technical activity to the business need and gives reviewers context for deciding whether the requested change should proceed.

Requested date

The requested date records when the change is intended to be deployed. Because changes are deployed outside business hours, the requested date should support planning for an appropriate deployment window.

Rollback plan

Every request includes a rollback plan. The plan provides the defined response if the deployment produces issues and allows the team to restore the previous state without waiting to create a new response plan.

Change classification

Standard changes

Standard changes use the pre-approved template. This provides a repeatable route for changes that have already been accepted as standard under the process.

Normal changes

Normal changes go through the change advisory board. The board provides the formal review route for changes that are not handled through the standard pre-approved path.

Emergency changes

Emergency changes have a separate approval treatment. They are approved verbally and documented within 24 hours.

Change Management Process — Approval

2. Approval

The approval route depends on the classification of the change.

Standard changes

Standard changes are auto-approved. They follow the pre-approved template and do not use the normal change approval sequence.

Normal changes

Normal changes require approval from the branch-IT lead and the affected department head. For financial system changes, the finance manager is also required.

The affected department head provides the business-side approval for the impacted department. The branch-IT lead provides the IT-side approval. Where the change affects a financial system, finance manager approval is added to the required approval set.

Emergency changes

Emergency changes are approved verbally and documented within 24 hours. The documentation requirement ensures that the emergency approval is subsequently captured in the formal change record.

Approval record

The change request should retain the applicable approval information so that the deployment can be traced back to its authorised route. The approval path should match the classification recorded for the request.

Approval before deployment

The process separates approval from deployment. The request must follow the appropriate approval route before the deployment activity proceeds, except that emergency changes use the specified verbal approval arrangement and are documented within 24 hours.

Change Management Process — Deployment and Verification

3. Deployment and Verification

Changes are deployed outside business hours. A verification checklist is executed and signed off after the change is deployed.

Deployment window

The outside-business-hours requirement reduces disruption to normal branch activities. The deployment team should use the approved requested date and planned change information when carrying out the work.

Verification checklist

The verification checklist is the formal check that the deployed change is operating as expected. It is executed after deployment and signed off to provide a recorded confirmation of the verification activity.

Verification should focus on the system or tooling affected by the change and confirm that the intended change has been applied without creating the issues covered by the rollback plan.

Issues after deployment

If issues arise, the rollback plan is invoked immediately. The process therefore treats the rollback plan as an active response mechanism rather than a document that is only reviewed after a failed change.

Rollback

Rollback restores the previous state according to the plan recorded in the original change request. The team should use the documented rollback approach promptly when issues are identified.

Post-mortem

When a rollback or deployment issue occurs, a post-mortem is written within seven days. The post-mortem provides a formal record of what happened and supports review of the change process.

Change Management Process — Operational Reference

Process Responsibilities

The IT department owns this change-management process. Changes may involve IT systems and tools used by other departments, so the approval path includes the affected department where the process requires it.

Request stage

The change requester provides the description, business justification, requested date and rollback plan through the IT service portal. The requester should ensure the record contains enough information for the applicable approval route.

Approval stage

Standard changes are auto-approved. Normal changes require the branch-IT lead and affected department head, plus the finance manager for financial system changes. Emergency changes are approved verbally and documented within 24 hours.

Deployment stage

Changes are deployed outside business hours. After deployment, the verification checklist is executed and signed off.

Failure and recovery

If issues arise, the rollback plan is invoked immediately. A post-mortem is then written within seven days.

Quick Reference

Request: File the change on the IT service portal with description, business justification, requested date and rollback plan.

Standard: Use the pre-approved template; standard changes are auto-approved.

Normal: Obtain branch-IT lead and affected department head approval; add finance manager approval for financial system changes.

Emergency: Obtain verbal approval and document it within 24 hours.

Deploy: Deploy outside business hours.

Verify: Execute and sign off the verification checklist.

Rollback: Invoke the rollback plan immediately if issues arise.

Post-mortem: Complete within seven days when issues arise.

Approval and Ownership

This document is owned by the IT department and approved by the Branch Manager. Questions or clarifications should be directed to the document owner.

Non-compliance is a disciplinary matter under the HR Policy Manual. The document owner is responsible for the annual review and revision of this controlled process document.